



**METHODIST
COLLEGE
BELFAST**

What's Next? Sixth Form Courses Information Booklet 2026-2027

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Introduction

You are about to make one of the most important decisions in your life. Your choice of A Level subjects will have an impact on your future study and career opportunities. The world of work is changing, and, in the future, you will be part of a dynamic, ever shifting employment landscape which will require you to have the academic qualifications needed for success in your chosen career **and** the skills and dispositions that will allow you to thrive throughout your career.

Methody offers a wide range of subjects which are designed to prepare you for life beyond the College, and you and your parents will be supported by our team of Careers Tutors so that you can make the best choice. When making your choices, *consider where your strengths lie, and which subjects you enjoy*. The depth and complexity of A Level courses compared to GCSE means you will have to spend many hours in school and at home over the next two years studying the subjects you have chosen. The subjects chosen should play to your strengths and interests.

This booklet is intended to help you make an informed decision. It includes up to date subject information which will assist you in your choices so please read it carefully. It is, however, only one part of the Careers and Employability programme listed below which is offered to you throughout the year in Form 5 and which is designed to give you as much information as possible to help you with your choices after your GCSE examinations.



Mrs J Lendrum
Principal

Form 5 Employability and Careers Programme 2025-2026

Date	Event
Thursday 6 November 2025	Form 5 Parents' Consultation
January 2026	DfE Careers Presentation during tutor group
December 2025 - January 2026	New subject presentations during tutor group
October 2025 – March 2026	Scheduled online interviews with the Careers Adviser from DfE
December 2025 – February 2026	Subject talks in class
Tuesday 6 th January 2026	Careers Day- including Subject Fair and Eye4Education Labour Market Information Sessions
Tuesday 17 February 2026	Form 5 Parents Information Evening
Monday 23 rd - Friday 27 th February 2026	Careers Interviews and completion of the A Level Choice form with a member of the MCB Careers team or a Vice-Principal.
Monday 2 nd March	Deadline for Submission of Choices Form
Thursday 20 th August 2026	GCSE Results Day

*Pupils at Stage 3 SEN Code of Practice will have an Annual Review including a Transition Review with the School's EA Transition Coordinator in attendance.

Entry Requirements

In addition to meeting the academic requirements outlined below, pupils are expected to have maintained a minimum attendance rate of 95% and demonstrated consistent positive behaviour and attitude throughout their time in school, unless there are exceptional circumstances as determined by the Principal.

The academic requirements for entry into Sixth Form are as follows:

1. Pathway 1: A minimum of 6 GCSE subjects at Grade C or above (all taken by the end of Form 5), including Grade C or higher in both GCSE English and Mathematics, and at least 3 GCSE subjects at Grade B or above; or
2. Pathway 2: A total GCSE points score of 12 (A* = 4 points, A = 3 points, B = 2 points, C* = 1 ½ points, C = 1 point) or higher, provided this includes at least a Grade C or higher in both GCSE English and Mathematics.
3. Pupils must have a viable course of 3 A Levels/BTECs to study. In addition to points 1 or 2 above,

pupils *must* meet the Subject Entry Criteria (outlined in this Options Booklet) for each subject they wish to take at A Level. Their subject combination must be timetable-compatible and have available places.

4. Pupils may request to take a 4th subject if they have attained 24 points or higher in their GCSEs. Pupils studying Further Mathematics must take a 4th subject.

In August, students who obtain less than the minimum entry requirements will have a meeting arranged with a Vice-Principal, to help them identify alternative pathways of progression.

What will my timetable in Sixth Form look like?

- Most students will take 3 subjects in Sixth Form. Some will take 4.
 - Supervised Study
 - Tutorial Period
 - Games (Optional)
 - Enrichment Programme (for those not partaking in Games)
1. In Lower Sixth, A Level subjects which are modular consist of an AS (Advanced Subsidiary) Level with external exams at the end of Lower Sixth. AS grades are then awarded. All CCEA A Levels will be modular, and the AS score will count towards 40% of the final A Level grade. However, subjects which are following an English examination board specification are linear. For these subjects, the AS is a separate qualification and as such will not count towards the final A Level grade at the end of Upper Sixth. It is our policy that students who are taking linear courses will not be entered for AS examinations in these subjects.

The following modular A Levels will be offered for courses starting in September 2026

Art and Design, Biology, Business Studies, Chemistry, Digital Technology, Economics, English Literature, Environmental Technology, French, Further Mathematics, Geography, German, Government and Politics, Health and Social Care, History, Mathematics, Moving Image Arts, Music, Nutrition and Food Science, Physics, Religious Studies, Spanish, Technology and Design.

The following linear A Levels will be offered for courses starting in September 2026

Classical Civilisation, Computer Science, Drama and Theatre, Latin, Psychology and Russian.

2. The College also offers the following courses which are modular and are equivalent to one A Level: BTEC in Travel and Tourism and BTEC in Sport.

Careers Interviews

All pupils in Form 5, along with their parents, will be asked to attend an interview with a member of the Careers Team or a Vice-Principal to talk about career aspirations and to fill in the choices form, which will then be passed to the Timetabling Office who will see if the subject combination chosen can be timetabled. These interviews will take place from 23rd February to 27th February 2026. It is possible to make a change to your choice of subjects after this date, by sending in a letter or email from a parent / guardian to Mrs Kelly as soon as possible, but any changes **are subject to timetabling constraints, such as class size, etc.** and may or may not be possible. All subject choices are provisional until Sixth Form entry requirements and individual subject entry criteria are met in August.

To help you prepare for this interview it is important that you **do some research** and **think** about how you would answer the following questions.

- *What subjects are necessary and/or advisable for a particular higher education course or career? What opportunities do the subjects I would like to take open up; which do they close down?*
- *Do my subject choices complement each other?*
- *Am I likely to be successful in these subjects?*
- *What are the skills and dispositions that I need to develop in order to be successful in my future working life and how will I develop them?*

Heads of Department of Computer Science, Environmental Technology, Health & Social Care, Nutrition and Food Science, Psychology, Sport and Travel & Tourism will give information about their specifications and the content of their subject in presentations to tutor groups. Teachers of other subjects will give you information about their subject during a timetabled lesson.

Please read the following information carefully

1. A subject will be timetabled provided a large enough number of students opt for it. In some cases, special arrangements may be made for subjects with small numbers, for example, the number of taught periods allocated to subjects with small pupil numbers may be reduced and periods of independent study for the students will be timetabled to ensure provision remains comparable with other subjects.
2. If any subject is oversubscribed a selection process will take place. This will be based upon GCSE grade, then total UMS score in the chosen subject, then total GCSE points, then Winter Exam performance at GCSE. If the subject has not been taken at GCSE, preference will be given to those who have taken it and achieved the entry requirements. If the subject has not or cannot be taken at GCSE then selection will be based upon total GCSE points.
3. If you choose Further Mathematics, you must also choose Mathematics and two other subjects. It is important to note that some universities will not accept Mathematics and Further Mathematics as distinct A Levels.
4. If you chose A Level Mathematics but have not studied Further Mathematics at GCSE, you will have an extra amount of time for Mathematics on your timetable in Lower Sixth.
5. Russian and Latin Lower Sixth and Upper Sixth classes are taught concurrently.
6. Digital Technology must not be chosen with Computer Science.
7. In Modern Languages, one period per week is allocated for a conversation class.

8. It is advisable to take no more than one BTEC subject as some Russell Group Universities make course-specific entry adjustments for BTEC courses.
9. You can take the following courses in 6th Form without having studied them at GCSE: Business Studies, Digital Technology, Economics, Environmental Technology, Geography, Government and Politics, Health and Social Care, History, Nutrition and Food Science, Psychology, Religious Studies, Sport (BTEC), Travel & Tourism (BTEC).

Please note, if you have taken any of these subjects for GCSE then you will be required to achieve the subject entry criteria as given in this booklet to take it forward into A Level as your grade at GCSE is an indicator of future success in the subject.

10. The relevant Head of Department may give approval for study to a student who demonstrates clear evidence of knowledge, understanding and aptitude for Computer Science, Drama and Theatre, Music or Technology and Design, without having taken the subject at GCSE. The decision may be based on a portfolio of work or an audition.

The Entitlement Framework

We are committed to providing access to the Entitlement Framework. If you want to study a subject not delivered by the College but by a school in the South Belfast Area Learning Community or Belfast Metropolitan College, you should contact the school and arrange to speak to Mr. Miller, Vice Principal.

It should be noted that as Methody runs a two-week timetable, this can affect the likelihood of finding a solution, and as timetables change each year, a solution that works for Lower Sixth cannot be guaranteed to work in Upper Sixth.

Sixth Form study is challenging. As well as qualifications you need to think about the skills and dispositions that will lead to success.

These include but are not limited to:

- Literacy and numeracy
- Time management and organisation
- Oral and written communication
- Teamwork
- Creative problem-solving
- Initiative and enterprise
- Critical and analytical thinking
- Ability to apply knowledge and concepts
- Information gathering, evaluation and synthesis
- Emotional intelligence and interpersonal skills
- Adaptability
- Dedication and Self-discipline
- Resilience and Grit

You should consider the following questions in relation to skills:

- **Analytical thinking** – do you possess the ability to break down a problem into its component parts, identifying implications and causal relationships?
- **Conceptual thinking** – can you recognise patterns and the key underlying issues, making the complex simple and finding creative solutions?
- **Teamwork** – are you good at working with others – seeing issues from another person's point of view? Are you willing and able to work co-operatively and collaboratively with others?
- **Communication and Influence** – can you be persuasive? Can you convince others of a view or position?
- **Leadership** – do you enjoy teamwork and co-operation while leading a group of people, articulating a purpose for the group, and motivating people to fulfil that purpose?

Subject Entry Criteria

Subject	Minimum GCSE subject grade and additional requirements	Alternative minimum requirements if not taken at GCSE (min grade B unless otherwise stated)
Art & Design	B in Art and Design B in English Language	
Biology	A grade in Biology (no foundation Biology papers can be taken).	AA in Double Award Science with A in Biology component.
Business Studies	B in Business Studies or C* in Business Studies with B in English Language.	B in English Language and B in Mathematics.
Chemistry	A grade in Chemistry and A in Mathematics (no foundation Chemistry papers can be taken).	AA in Double Award Science with A in Chemistry component and A in GCSE Mathematics.
Classical Civilisation		B in any of the following: History or English Language or English Literature or Latin or RE
Computer Science	A in CCEA Digital Technology (Programming) and B in Mathematics or A in AQA/OCR/WJEC Computer Science and B in Mathematics	HOD approval on evidence of acceptable level of programming ability and A in Mathematics
Digital Technology	C* in Digital Technology / Computer Science	B in English Language
Drama & Theatre Studies	6 in Drama and B in English Literature	HOD approval on acceptable audition along with B in English Language and B in English Literature
Economics	B	B in English Language and B in Mathematics
English Literature	A in English Lit and B in English Language	HOD approval if B in English Lit and A in English Language
Environmental Technology		B in Mathematics, Technology or Physics or BB in Double Award Science
French	B	
Geography	B	B in English Language and Mathematics
German	B	
Government & Politics	B	B in English Language or B in History
Health & Social Care	B	B in English Language

History	B	A in English Literature or A in English Language
Latin	6	
Mathematics (Route 1)	A in Mathematics (must have sat M4/M8) and B in Further Mathematics	
Mathematics (Route 2)	A in Mathematics (M4/M8)	
Further Mathematics	A* Further Mathematics and A* in Mathematics	
Moving Image Arts	B	
Music	B and Grade 5 instrument or voice	HOD approval on acceptable audition
Nutrition & Food Science	B in Food and Nutrition	B Biology or Chemistry or BB in Double Award Science
Physics	A grade in Physics and A in Mathematics (no foundation Physics papers can be taken).	AA in Double Award Science with A in Physics component and A in GCSE Mathematics
Psychology		A, B, B from Mathematics, English Language and Science (Chemistry, Physics or Biology or a BB in Double Award Science). Please note that whilst ABB is required, the A grade can be achieved in any of the 3 subjects
Religious Studies	B	B in English Language or B in History
Russian	6	
Spanish	B	
Sport (BTEC)		C* English Language and Mathematics
Technology and Design	B	B in Mathematics or Physics or BB in Double Award Science with B in Physics component
Travel and Tourism (BTEC)		C* English Language and Mathematics

In certain circumstances and if there is space in the class a C may be considered in the following subjects: Digital Technology, Environmental Technology, French, German and Russian.*

Comparison of CCEA GCSE Grades with the 9-1 system used in England

CCEA Structure	9 – 1 Structure
A*	9
A	8
	7
B	6
C*	5
C	4
D	3
E	3 / 2
F	2 / 1
G	1

Art and Design (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Requirements

Essential

Grade B or above at GCSE. Candidates coming from schools who do not sit the CCEA GCSE will be asked to provide a portfolio as evidence of suitability for this course.

Desirable

A grade B or above in English Language due to the requirement for extended writing at A2. Strong skills in drawing from first-hand (from life) and strong problem-solving skills. An ability to juggle coursework deadlines and to work independently to devise ideas for personal investigations arising from a set theme. Strong skills in research and extended writing are needed for the 1,000-2,000-word A2 Written Investigation. A willingness to take creative risks. A keen interest in historical and contemporary issues in Art and Design.

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Experimental Portfolio A balance of directed creative and expressive workshops and self-directed research and investigation arising from a set theme	AS 1: Experimental Portfolio 50% of AS, 20% of A Level
AS 2: Personal Response Focused investigations leading to a substantial outcome arising from set theme	AS 2: Personal Response 50% of AS, 20% of A Level
A2 1: Personal and Critical Investigation Self-directed research and investigation arising from set theme. A 1,000- 2000-word Written Investigation	A21: Personal and Critical Investigation Practical Work 40% of A2, 24% of A Level Written Investigation 20% of A2, 12% of A Level
A2 2: Thematic Outcome Focused investigations leading to a substantial outcome arising from set theme.	A22: Thematic Outcome 40% of A2, 24% of A Level CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Students will either choose a Foundation Course in Art and Design or opt for direct entry to a specialist degree course.

Employment

Students will either choose a Foundation Course in Art and Design or opt for direct entry to a specialist degree course.

Other

Apprenticeships for young people are available through organisations such as Northern Ireland Creative Employment Programme and NI Screen.

From a student:

"A Level Art and Design really allows you to explore a range of techniques and media in a truly expressive way. Compared to GCSE we have more freedom to find what intrigues us within art. The A Level specification is very loose, and you have more control, allowing you gain more confidence and independence. A Level Art and Design gives you transferable skills that are useful in industries other than the creative industries too."

Biology (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Requirements

Essential

Grade A or above in Biology for pupils following the GCSE Biology course. **No foundation papers** can be taken. Double Award Science AA with A grade in Biology elements.

Desirable

Pupils should have studied GCSE Chemistry as a single science or as part of Double Award. The study of Chemistry at A Level alongside Biology would be of benefit for some topics.

Content	Assessment
At each level, AS and A2, students must study all three units.	AS 1: 15% of A Level External written exam 1 hour 30 minutes. Students answer six to eight structured questions and write an essay.
AS 1: Molecules and Cells	AS 2: 15% of A Level
AS 2: Organisms and Biodiversity	External written exam 1 hour 30 minutes. Students answer six to eight structured questions and write an essay.
AS 3: Practical Skills in AS Biology	AS 3: 10% of A Level
A2 1: Physiology, Coordination and Control, and Ecosystems	External written exam assessing practical skills 1 hour. Internal practical assessment.
A2 2: Biochemistry, Genetics and Evolutionary Trends	A2 1: 24% of A Level
A2 3: Practical Skills in A2 Biology	External written exam 2 hours 15 minutes. Students answer six to nine structured questions and write an essay.
	A2 2: 24% of A Level
	External written exam 2 hours 15 minutes. Students answer six to nine structured questions and write an essay.
	A2 3: 12% of A Level
	External written exam assessing practical skills 1 hour 15 minutes.
	Internal practical assessment
	CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Biology is essential for the study of Medicine, Dentistry and Veterinary in most institutions and highly desirable for studying Pharmacy. There are many other Biology based degrees including Biological Sciences, Genetics, Zoology etc.

Employment

The study of Biology is useful in a range of jobs, including the health industry, food production and environmental health, conservation and the ever-expanding biotechnology industry.

Other

Biology gives an understanding and respect for living organisms. Students develop valued skills including analysis, evaluation, problem solving, research and an ability to understand complex processes, along with practical skills such as using a microscope, fieldwork, and handling apparatus.

From a student:

"I studied Biology at A Level to allow me to apply for medical degrees. However, it has always been of personal interest and is a subject that is relevant to most people. There is a lot to learn at A Level but there is also lots of practical work and it is really interesting."

Business Studies (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in Business Studies **or** grade C* or above in Business Studies with a B in English Language. If you do not have GCSE Business Studies, a grade B or above in Mathematics is required along with a grade B or above in English Language.

Desirable

An interest in business related content, ability to be creative and innovative as well as willingness to undertake additional reading around business topics.

Content

AS 1: Introduction to Business: This unit begins with what motivates individuals to develop business enterprises. Topics include: the importance of quality, recruitment, management and leadership styles, employee motivation and business operations.

AS 2: Growing the Business: Students explore the role of technology in growing a business as well as topics such as marketing and the use of e-business. Students develop an appreciation of the role of accounting and financial information in business decision making and financial control.

A2 1: Strategic Decision Making: Students identify business objectives as well as how conflict can occur among various stakeholders. Students gain an insight into business planning and how to manage risk and uncertainty when developing business strategies through decision tools as well as the use of accounting and financial information.

A2 2: The Competitive Business Environment: Students examine the macroeconomic framework and the impact of globalisation on business activities. Students develop an appreciation of the importance of ethics and sustainability on business decision making and culture as well as how businesses are affected by and react to a change in the dynamic and technology-driven business environment.

Assessment

AS 1: External written examination
1 hour 30 minutes: Two compulsory structured data responses.

AS 2: External written examination
1 hour 30 minutes: Two compulsory structured data responses.

A2 1: External written examination
2 hours: Five compulsory structured data responses.

A2 2: External written examination
2 hours: Six compulsory structured data responses.

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Business Studies continues to be one of the most popular university and career pathways for students leaving Methodist College. It provides students with an excellent broad-based preparation for careers and degrees in management, accountancy, product development, marketing, investment banking, international business, finance, actuary, retail or simply running your own business. Some of our students have recently entered apprenticeships with companies such as PWC. Throughout the course, students will experience guest speakers and the opportunity to visit businesses to see how theory learnt in the classroom can be carried across into the real business world.

From a student:

"I have really enjoyed studying Business Studies and now hope to go on to study a business-related course at University. I believe studying Business Studies at A Level has allowed me to gain confidence in my overall ability as well as developing key skills in areas such as organisation, critical-thinking and communication a creating a wide knowledge of how the business world works. Most importantly, these transferrable skills are key in preparing me for the demands of future employment."

Chemistry (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade A or above in Chemistry and Mathematics.

No foundation papers can be taken.

Grade AA with A grades in the Chemistry elements of Double Award Science and A in Mathematics.

Desirable

An interest in the subject and science in general.

Content

AS 1: Basic Concepts in Physical and Inorganic Chemistry

AS 2: Further Physical and Inorganic Chemistry and an Introduction to Organic Chemistry

AS 3: Basic Practical Chemistry

A2 1: Further Physical and Organic Chemistry

A2 2: Analytical, Transition Metals, Electrochemistry and Organic Nitrogen Chemistry

A2 3: Further Practical Chemistry

[CCEA Specification](#)

Assessment

AS 1: External written examination. 1 hour 30 minutes. (90 marks)

AS 2: External written examination. 1 hour 30 minutes. (90 marks)

AS 3: Practical Booklet A. 1 hour 15 minutes. (25 marks).

Practical Booklet B. 1 hour 15 minutes. (55 marks).

A2 1: External written examination. 2 hours (110 marks)

A2 2: External written examination. 2 hours (110 marks)

A2 3: Practical Booklet A. 1-hour 15minutes. (30 marks).

Practical Booklet B. 1 hour 15 minutes. (60 marks)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Chemistry, biochemistry, biomedical sciences, medicine, dentistry, veterinary science, forensic science

Employment

Laboratory technician, Research and Development, Pharmacy technician

Other

Biotechnology, Oil and gas, Food, Pharmaceuticals, Sustainable energy, Management

From a student:

"A Level Chemistry presents an unparalleled opportunity for lovers of problem solving as it is all about making connections between many of the topics studied at GCSE and the more in-depth understanding of them. There is a real satisfaction to be gained from the various aspects of the course falling into place.

Classical Civilisation (OCR, Linear)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade 6 or above if Classical Civilisation has been taken at GCSE (OCR). Those who have not studied Classical Civilisation at GCSE Level must have obtained a Grade B (or equivalent) in a subject such as History, English Language, English Literature, Latin or Religious Studies.

Desirable

As the course is quite varied in nature, it should appeal to those with an interest in literature, politics, drama or history who wish to gain a knowledge and understanding of the literature and culture of the Greeks and Romans through studying a diverse range of ancient material.

Content

Unit 1: The World of the Hero: Homer's *Odyssey* and Virgil's *Aeneid*: This component is solely focused on the study of Greek and Roman literature in translation.

Unit 2: Culture and Arts: Imperial Image: Through an examination of literature and visual/material culture, this component looks at the ways in which the Emperor Augustus conveyed his personal brand of rule to all the social classes of Rome.

Unit 3: Beliefs and Ideas: Democracy and the Athenians: The aim of this component is to examine the birth and development of democracy, what this meant to an Athenian and its positive and negative aspects as expressed by historians, dramatists and commentators.

Assessment

Three written papers are taken at the end of Upper Sixth.

Unit 1: 2 hours 20 minutes – 40%.

Unit 2: 1 hour 45 minutes – 30%.

Unit 3: 1 hour 45 minutes – 30%.

Examination paper questions are varied and range in length from short answers to full length essays. Source-based questions appear on all the papers.

[OCR Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Classical Civilisation can be studied at degree level on its own or in combination with other subjects.

Employment

The transferable skills gained are useful in a wide range of occupations such as author, historian, teacher, lecturer, civil servant, journalist, researcher, politician, diplomat and lawyer.

From a student:

"Classical Civilisation has been an enjoyable subject to study due to the diverse areas of the Greek and Roman worlds covered. It has been interesting to read through two of the world's greatest epics, to look at how the concept of democracy was born in Athens over 2500 years ago and how the first Roman emperor Augustus, much like many politicians today, sought to present his public image in a positive way. I have developed my research, analytical and critical thinking skills and found out that many of the burning issues of today were around in ancient times too!"

Computer Science (AQA, Linear)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade A in CCEA Digital Technology (Programming) and B Grade in Mathematics or Grade A in AQA/OCR/WJEC Computer Science and B Grade in Mathematics

Desirable

Good problem-solving ability Logical thinking skills
Willingness to persevere with a task in order to develop an efficient, working solution

Content

AS 1: Paper 1 - On-screen examination

AS 2: Paper 2 - Written examination

A2 1: Paper 1 - On-screen examination

This paper tests a student's ability to program, as well as their theoretical knowledge of computer science

A2 2: Paper 2 - Written examination

This paper tests a student's theoretical knowledge of computer science

A2 3: Non-examination assessment

The non-exam assessment assesses student's ability to use the knowledge and skills gained through the course to solve or investigate a practical problem.

Assessment

A2 1: 2 hours 30-minutes on-screen examination (40%)

A2 2: 2 hours 30 minutes written examination (40%)

A2 3: Non-examination assessment (20%)

[AQA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Applied Computing
Computer Science Software
Engineering

Employment

Earn as You Learn schemes (e.g.,
Kainos)
Apprenticeships (e.g., Deloitte
Brightstart)

Other

www.bcs.org
<https://www.careers.ox.ac.uk/computing-it/>

From a student:

"The opportunities in the Computing industry are increasing. It is a thriving industry and will allow me to work anywhere in the world, on lots of different projects. I may decide not to be a programmer but know that, with my A Level, I will be able to choose from a diverse range of careers. In fact, the jobs I will do may not exist yet – that is exciting!"

Digital Technology (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

C* Grade in Digital Technology / Computer Science. If IT or Digital Technology are not taken at GCSE, then B Grade in English Language.

Desirable

Good problem-solving ability

Willingness to persevere with a task in order to develop an efficient, working solution.

Content

AS 1: Approaches to Systems Development

Develop knowledge & understanding of approaches to development of systems

AS 2: Fundamentals of Digital Technology

Develop knowledge and understanding of fundamentals of any system

A2 1: Information Systems

An extension to Unit AS 2

A2 2: Application Development (Case Study)

Apply skills, knowledge and understanding of digital technology to solve a problem for a specified client

Assessment

AS 1: 1 hour 30 mins external written examination;
Students answer short and extended questions (20%)

AS 2: 1 hour 30 mins external written examination
Students answer short and extended questions (20%)

A2 1: 2 hours 30 mins external written examination
Students answer short and extended questions (40%)

A2 2: Internal assessment

Students compile a portfolio showing evidence of the analysis, design, development, testing and evaluation of an application for a specified end user (20%)

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Some of the current options: Software Engineering with Digital Technology Partnership; Business Information Technology; Computing and Information Technology; Animation; Graphic Design; Intermedia Art; Games Design; Information Technologies or any Digital Technology / Information Technology / ICT course

Education and Employment

You may wish to consider apprenticeships – work for a company and study at the same time – earn a salary and have all your fees paid

Other

“If you’re thinking of continuing on to higher education, it is important to check that the combination of subjects and qualifications you are planning to study will satisfy the requirements of the undergraduate course at the unis or colleges you’re thinking of applying to.” (UCAS)

From a student:

“Digital Technology has allowed me to develop my practical computer skills, in particular, the use of databases. Through the development of my solution for the case study, I understand the importance of problem-solving skills and have become more independent when solving problems. I realise that no matter what career path I choose, computers, in some format, will play a large part in my day-to-day tasks

Drama and Theatre (EDEXCEL, Linear)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or 6 or above in both GCSE Drama **and** GCSE English Literature. If Drama has not been taken at GCSE, then students may be considered with grade B in both English Literature and English Language along with an acceptable audition with Head of Department.

Desirable

Grade A in GCSE English Language

Content

Unit 1: Devising Students will devise an original performance piece using one key extract from a performance text and the methods and ideas of a key influential theatre practitioner (10%). Written coursework detailing the process from Page to Stage (30%).

Unit 2: Text in Performance Students will be expected to design or perform one key extract from a performance text, in a group, to an external examiner. Students will design or perform a group piece (13%) and a monologue or duologue (7%) from one key extract from the different performance texts to an external examiner.

Unit 3: Theatre Makers in Practice Students will study a piece of live Theatre and two performance texts, to be chosen by the Drama department. They will practically explore and interpret the work, utilising the work of theatre practitioners, to complete a written examination.

Assessment

Unit 1: Devising (80 marks and 40% of the qualification) Portfolio (60 marks) and Devised Performance (20 marks)

Unit 2: Text in Performance (60 marks and 20% of the qualification) Group Performance and Monologue/Duologue (60 marks)

Unit 3: Theatre Makers in Practice (80 marks and 40% of the qualification) Written examination: 2 hours 30 minutes

Section A: Live Theatre Evaluation

Section B: Page to Stage: Realising a Performance Text

Section C: Interpreting a Performance Text

[EDEXCEL Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Performing Arts Degree
Law Degree
Communications Degree
Bachelor of Arts in Drama

Employment

Professional Acting/Musical Theatre
Law
Advertising
Teaching

From a student:

"I have thoroughly enjoyed Drama because it has taught me a wide range of styles, methods and techniques that I have been able to put into practice when performing both inside and outside of school. A Level Drama has exposed me to a variety of practitioners and styles which have helped me develop a better performance style. The theory side has provided me with a greater understanding of stage craft and therefore developed my acting as a whole."

Economics (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Minimum of grade B in GCSE Economics. If you do not have GCSE Economics, a grade B or above in Mathematics is required along with a grade B or above in English Language.

Desirable

An interest in current economic affairs, the ability to think critically and logically as well as ability to problem solve.

Content

AS 1: Markets and Market Failure: Students consider how market forces of supply and demand interact to allocate resources in local, national and international markets. Students will look at different forms of market failure and will evaluate possible methods of government intervention to remedy market failures.

AS 2: Managing the National Economy: Students analyse the impact of economic growth, inflation, unemployment and the balance of payments. They will assess the likely impact and effectiveness of different government policies.

A2 1: Business Economics: Students will examine what factors affect the nature of competition between firms. Students will examine how some firms are profit maximisers, yet others may have alternative business objectives. They also analyse and evaluate competition policy.

A2 2: Managing the Economy in a Global World:

Students get the opportunity to understand the significance of globalisation, international trade, the balance of payments and exchange rates. They will analyse public finance, macroeconomic policies and the role of the financial sector in a global context.

Assessment

AS-1: 1 hour 30 minutes written examination consisting of short-answer questions, a multi-part data response question and one extended open-response question from a choice of two.

AS-2: 1 hour 30 minutes written examination consisting of short-answer questions, a multi-part data response question and one extended open-response question from a choice of two.

A2-1: 2 hour written examination consisting of short-answer questions, a multi-part data response question and one open-response question from a choice of two.

A2-2: 2 hour written examination consisting of short-answer questions, a multi-part data response question and one open-response question from a choice of two.

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Employers place a high value on those who study Economics. Careers and university pathways include economist, banking, accountancy, data analyst, financial risk analyst, government economist, statistician, actuary, management consultant and stockbroker. Throughout their studies, students are exposed to situations where they will learn to develop a wide range of valuable transferable skills, including communication, numeracy, problem solving, time management and analytical skills.

From a student:

"Studying Economics completely changes the way in which you view the world. What is unique about Economics is the way you learn basic theories but are then able to think about them broadly and apply them to a range of real-life examples - something which you do not have the opportunity to do in other subjects. I would recommend Economics to anyone who has an interest in current affairs, politics or fundamentally wants to understand how the world works."

English Literature (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade A or above in English Literature **and** B or above in English Language. If B in English Literature and A in English Language is achieved then HOD approval is required.

Desirable

Strong performance in Examination Units in GCSE English Language and Literature. A clear track record of punctuality and adherence to deadlines. A good grade at GCSE does not guarantee success at A Level: we seek pupils who can demonstrate an active interest in Literature and reading both inside and outside of the classroom.

Content

AS 1: The Study of Poetry 1900-Present and Drama 1900-present: A Streetcar Named Desire by Tennessee Williams and selected poems by Robert Frost and Seamus Heaney.

AS 2: The Study of Prose Pre-1900: Wuthering Heights by Emily Bronte.

A2 1: Shakespearean Genres: King Lear.

A2 2: The Study of Poetry Pre-1900 and unseen poetry

A2 3: Internal assessment

Assessment

AS 1: 2-hour examination

AS 2: 1-hour examination

A2 1: 1 hour 30 minutes examination

A2 2: 2-hour examination

A2 3: Internal assessment: 2500-word essay

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

English, Teaching, Journalism, Law, History, Politics, Classics, Media, Film, Current Affairs.

Employment

Teaching, Law, Journalism, Media & TV, editorial work, research & investigation.

Other

Covers a range of highly enabling skills, supremely applicable in future pathways.

From a student:

"Not only is the subject enjoyable and challenging, but there is an inherent quality and depth to the student who has committed to studying literature at such a rigorous level: you will emerge with an extremely marketable skill-set."

Environmental Technology (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in Mathematics, Technology or Physics, or BB in Double Award Science. However, a C* may be considered if the student has achieved a grade C* or above in Mathematics and English Language along with a science-based subject at GCSE.

Desirable

Having studied Technology or Physics at GCSE would be an advantage.

Content

AS 1:

Earth's Capacity to Support Human Activity: how the use of fossil fuels affects climate and the environment and what action can be taken to mitigate this.

AS 2: Internal Assessment: An evaluation, by desktop research and practical investigation of a scenario for the installation of renewable energy technologies.

A2 1:

Building and Managing a Sustainable Future:
How human action affects climate and the environment and how technology can be taken to mitigate this.

A2 2: Internal Assessment:

An evaluation of a building, by desktop research and practical investigation of a scenario to the code for sustainable homes.

Assessment

AS 1: Written paper 1 hour 30 minutes 50% of AS, 20% A2

AS 2: Internal Assessment
Renewable Energy Technologies
50% of AS, 20% of A2

A2 1: Written paper 2 hours 30 % A2

A2 2: Internal Assessment
Environmental Building Performance and Measurement
30% of A2

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Many elements of the course echo the BEng degree offered by Energy and Building Services Engineering in UU

Employment

Significant employment opportunities in engineering, planning, manufacturing, technical support and management. Modern Apprenticeships.

From a student:

"This subject is becoming increasingly relevant with more jobs and university courses arising in the Environment sector. The subject is 50% coursework based so if you devote enough time and effort into it and revise well for the examination, very high grades can be achieved."

French (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in GCSE French

Desirable

An interest in the subject or country. A desire to study a wide range of topics including Cinema, Music, Health matters, Education, Politics and Family and Relationships

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Speaking AS 2: Listening, Reading and Use of Language AS 3: Extended Writing A2 1: Speaking A2 2: Listening and Reading A2 3: Extended Writing	AS 1: 11 minutes presentation and conversation AS 2: 40 minutes Listening and 1 hr 20 minutes Reading paper AS 3: 1-hour Writing paper A2 1: Speaking research topic 6 minutes, Conversation 9 minutes A2 2: Listening 45 minutes, Reading 2 hours 45 minutes A2 3: Extended Writing 1 hour CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Interpreting and translating; Teaching; Civil Service; International Organisations; Industry and Commerce; Travel; Tourism; Hotel and catering work; Journalism; Scientific work. Careers possibilities.

From a student:

"Studying French has allowed me to improve my communication skills. This is essential as I hope to go on to study Medicine. Upon contacting various universities, I was told that French set me apart from other students who were applying for the courses, and I should continue with it into A2 if possible as it showed excellent interpersonal skills. Through studying French, I have had the opportunity to study both a film and a text and have really enjoyed how different it is to my other subjects. I have also enjoyed the opportunity to travel to France with my friends and experience life in Paris."

Further Mathematics (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Grade A* in both GCSE Mathematics and GCSE Further Mathematics. This course is intended for students who have a real interest in and enjoyment of Mathematics and have proven themselves to be capable mathematicians. Students will sit AS/A2 Mathematics in their L6th year. To continue to AS/A2 Further Mathematics in their U6th year, students are expected to achieve at least an A grade at A2 Mathematics in L6th. Students who do not achieve this standard will instead repeat the A2 Mathematics course in U6th. This subject will run over 2 subject choice blocks in each year.

Content AS Further Mathematics AS1 Pure Mathematics Further algebra and functions, Complex numbers, Matrices, Vectors, Exponentials and logarithms, Differentiation, Integration, Vectors AS2 Applied Mathematics [Mechanics/Statistics] Hook's law, Work / energy / power, Circular motion, Sampling / probability, Statistical distributions, Bivariate distributions Assessment AS1 Written examination 1 hour 30 minutes AS2 Written examination 1 hour 30 minutes	Content A2 Further Mathematics A21 Pure Mathematics Further algebra and functions, Proof by induction, Further complex numbers, Further calculus, Polar co-ordinates, Hyperbolic functions, Differential equations, Numerical methods A22 Applied Mathematics [Mechanics/Statistics] Simple harmonic motion / damped oscillations, Centre of mass / frameworks, Further circular motion, Linear combinations of independent variables, Sampling and estimation, t-distribution / χ^2 test Assessment A21 Written examination 2 hours 15 minutes A22 Written examination 2 hours 15 minutes CCEA Specification
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What can you do with this subject?

This course provides an excellent basis for those wishing to study courses at university which contain significant mathematical content. Students will not have met many of the topics outlined above with the course providing significant challenge and extending mathematical thinking skills. As a STEM subject, the skills developed in studying AS/A2 Further Mathematics are valued by both universities and employers, especially in the growth employment sectors. A student considering applying to Oxford or Cambridge to study Mathematics, Engineering, Computing or one (or more) of the Physical Sciences would find it an advantage to study both Mathematics and Further Mathematics at AS/A2 Level.

From a student:

"I have always enjoyed the challenge that Mathematics has presented and by taking AS/A2 Further Mathematics I was able to study topics and concepts which extended my thinking skills and overall interest in the subject. Whilst the content at A2 Level can be demanding, the tailored resources produced by the department facilitates sound understanding of topics and provides a range of consolidation exercises up to and including examination style questions."

Geography (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in GCSE Geography. Those who have not studied GCSE Geography must have grade B in both English Language **and** Mathematics.

Desirable

Students have studied GCSE Geography **and** a Science. As written communication and elements of Mathematics are key components of Geography A Level, grade B in both Mathematics and English Language at GCSE are good indicators of success.

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Physical Geography: Rivers, Ecosystems, Weather and Climate	AS 1: Physical Geography 1 hour 15 minutes 40% of AS – 16% of A Level
AS 2: Human Geography: Population, Settlement, Development	AS 2: Human Geography 1 hour 15 minutes 40% of AS – 16% of A Level
AS 3: Fieldwork and Skills	AS 3: Fieldwork Skills and Techniques 1 hour 20% of AS – 8% of A Level
A2 1: Physical Processes, Landforms and Management: Plate Tectonics – Theory and Outcomes, Dynamic Coastal Environments	A2 1: Physical Processes, Landforms and Management 1 hour 30 minutes 24% of A Level
A2 2: Processes and Issues in Human Geography: Ethnic Diversity, Tourism	A2 2: Process and Issues in Human Geography 1 hour 30 minutes 24% of A Level
A2 3: Decision Making in Geography	A2 3: Decision Making in Geography 1 hour 30 minutes 12% of A Level

What can you do with this subject?

Further/Higher Education

Geography, Geology, Earth Sciences, Engineering, Medicine, Law, PPE, Marketing, Sociology, Business, Architecture, Finance

Employment

Cartographer, Surveyor, Teacher, Town Planner, International development / aid worker, Landscape architect, GIS officer, Environmental Consultant

Other

Geography gives students an understanding of the world around them. Students develop valuable skills including field work, data collection and analysis, map work, GIS and problem solving.

From a student:

"I like A Level Geography because the classes are always engaging as we are learning about the different processes that happen in the world around us. The topics are all interesting and they can be directly linked to all aspects of real life."

German (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B at CCEA or level 6 at GCSE (AQA) or equivalent

Desirable

An interest in effective communication with others.

A willingness to develop your cultural and critical sensitivity.

A desire to learn more about literature, the arts, intellectual ideas, linguistics and history

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Speaking AS 2: Listening, Reading, Use of Language AS 3: Extended writing A2 1: Speaking A2 2: Listening, Reading A2 3: Extended Writing The topics covered are Relationships and Culture and Lifestyle (AS) and Young People in Society and Our Place in a Changing World (A2)	AS 1: 3-minute Presentation and 8-minute conversation AS 2: Listening and reading comprehension, grammatical and lexical exercises AS 3: One essay in German in response to a set film or literary text A2 1: 1-minute presentation, 5-minute discussion and 9-minute conversation A2 2: Listening and Reading A2 3: One essay in German in response to a literary text. CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education:

It is possible to study German on its own or jointly with other subjects, such as another language, business or management.

Employment:

Education, Journalism, Broadcasting, International Business, Advertising and Marketing, Tourism, Civil and Public Service, Diplomacy

Other

Academic and research Communities

From a student:

"Learning German increases university and employment opportunities as you are not restricted to just English-speaking countries. German has allowed me to develop my analytical skills and visiting Germany hugely improved my confidence in terms of communicating with others. In this way, A Level German has given me important skills for any future career."

Government and Politics (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in Politics, or if not studied at GCSE a B in English Language or History.

Desirable

Keen interest in current affairs and politics

Content

AS 1: The Government and Politics of Northern Ireland

- The Northern Ireland Assembly
- The Northern Ireland Executive
- Political Parties in Northern Ireland

AS 2: The British Political Process

- The House of Commons
- The House of Lords
- Prime Minister & Cabinet
- Pressure Groups in the UK

A2 1: Option A: A Comparative Study of the Government and Politics of the United States of America and the United Kingdom

- Congress
- President
- Comparative study between Parliament/Prime Minister in the UK and Congress/President in the USA

A2 2: Option A: Political Power

- Exercise of Political Power
- Theories of Political Power

Assessment

AS 1: Written examination. 1 hour 15 minutes

AS 2: Written examination. 1 hour 45 minutes

A2 1: Written examination. 2 hours 15 minutes

A2 2: Written examination. 1 hour 30 minutes

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Government and Politics, History, English Language, English Literature, General Studies, Economics

Employment

Law, business, finance, government services, education, journalism, public relations or political research.

From a student:

"Government and Politics as a subject is both relevant and useful. I study this subject as it allows me to engage in meaningful conversation around BREXIT and Trump with my peers. Discussion in class is always fresh and engaging as we debate the big issues in today's society."

Health and Social Care (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential - Grade B or above in GCSE English Language.

Desirable - Grade B or above in Biology.

Points to note:

As part of this course pupils have to find their own placement in a Health and Social care setting for periods throughout the year for example a hospital, day centre, nursery school or primary school. This subject requires a considerable amount of extended writing therefore quality of written communication needs to be of a high standard to succeed. A key is to consider the proportion of portfolio work required. This form of assessment can be beneficial to students who prefer working regularly on substantial pieces of work whilst being assessed throughout. Please note that some sensitive topics are dealt with in this subject. See specification for more information.

Content

AS Unit 1: Promoting Quality Care - students investigate how care workers apply the values of care on a daily basis with service users.

AS Unit 2: Communication in Health, Social Care and Early Years Settings – students examine communication skills, factors that support effective communication and barriers to communication observed in a health and social care setting.

AS Unit 3: Health and Well-Being – students learn about key concepts of health and well-being and the impact of ill health.

A2 Unit 2: Body Systems and Physiological

Disorders – students examine the circulatory and respiratory systems and research a physiological disorder of their own choice.

A2 Unit 3: Providing Services – this examined unit based on pre-release material provides students with an overview of service provision in the health and social care sectors.

A2 Unit 5: Supporting the Family - this unit provides students with the opportunity to consider the changing family structures in today's society. Students develop an understanding of a range of factors that influence family life and investigate the services available to families.

Assessment

AS Unit 1: Internal assessment 10% of A Level.

AS Unit 2: Internal assessment 10% of A Level.

AS Unit 3: External 2 hour written assessment 20% of AS level.

A2 Unit 2: Internal assessment 15% of A Level.

A2 Unit 3: Providing Services – External 2 hour written assessment 30% of A Level.

A2 Unit 5: Supporting the Family - Internal assessment 15% of A Level.

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Studying Health and Social Care will enable students to gain skills that are valued in further and higher education, as well as in the workplace. Many students who complete this A Level, continue to third level education to study a range of courses including childcare, nursing, midwifery, social work, occupational therapy, speech therapy, physiotherapy, teaching and similar careers. A wide range of courses are available at colleges and universities.

From a student:

“Health and Social Care allowed me to gain an in-depth understanding of health and well-being and the health care industry. This course is greatly beneficial for those thinking about pursuing a career in health and social care, such as nursing, dietician etc. The coursework allowed me to gain experience in researching and writing concise reports, which may be of benefit when producing similar reports at university.”

History (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above if GCSE History has been taken.

Those who have not studied GCSE History must have grade A in either English Literature or English Language.

Desirable

Keen interest in the past, and developing analytical skills

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Germany 1919-45 AS 2: Russia 1914-41	Assessment AS 1: 1 hour 30 minutes – 50% of AS and 20% of A Level. Students answer a short response question and a two-part source question. AS 2: 1 hour 30 minutes – 50% of AS and 20% of A Level. Students answer two questions from a choice of three. Each question has two parts, a short response and an extended essay.
A2 1: Ireland Under the Union 1800-1900 A2 2: Partition of Ireland 1900-25	A2 1: 1 hour and 15 mins – 50% of A2 and 20% of A Level. Students answer a synoptic essay. A2 2: 2 hours 30 minutes – 40% of A Level. Students answer three questions – source and essay questions. CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Many History students go to university and study Law, Journalism, PPE, accountancy, History

Employment

Analytical, communication and recall skills learned can lead to employment in a range of jobs

Other

A well respected and recognized subject which for many becomes a hobby later in life!

From a student:

“Studying history has given me the confidence to challenge others’ opinions. We are encouraged to research and then come to our own conclusions about a range of topics – we often have debates in class showing a full range of viewpoints. They often get quite lively – I love it!”

Latin (OCR, Linear)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade 6 or above in GCSE Latin in either the EDUQAS or OCR examination.

Desirable

An interest in developing a more detailed knowledge of the Latin language, acquiring the literary skills to read Latin literature, both prose and verse, with appropriate attention to literary techniques, styles and genres and applying analytical and evaluative skills.

Content	Assessment
Unit 1: Unseen Prose and Verse Translation The content builds on GCSE vocabulary and grammar and the unseen writers are known in advance – Livy for prose and Ovid for verse.	Four written papers are taken at the end of Upper Sixth. Unit 1: 1 hour 45 minutes – 33%.
Unit 2: Unseen Latin Comprehension Questions are answered on a passage from a prose writer.	Unit 2: 1 hour 15 minutes – 17%.
Unit 3: Prose Set Texts Passages in Latin from Nepos <i>Life of Hannibal</i> and in Latin and English from Tacitus <i>Annals</i> Book 4 are studied.	Unit 3: 2 hours – 25%.
Unit 4: Verse Set Texts Passages in Latin and English from Virgil <i>Aeneid</i> Book 4 are studied.	Unit 4: 2 hours – 25%.
	Prose and verse set texts are tested by comprehension, translation and short essays.
	OCR Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Latin can be studied at degree level on its own or in combination with other subjects.

Employment

The transferable skills gained are useful in a wide range of occupations such as author, accountant, computer operator, teacher, diplomat, civil servant, financial manager and

Other

Latin is classed as a facilitating subject by the [Russell Group of universities](#).

From a student:

“Latin will provide you with a unique perspective on languages as it allows you to see from where many modern languages have originated. It helps to develop skills such as analysis, critical thinking and problem-solving, skills which would be especially useful in a variety of careers. Through studying Latin, you will also explore some Roman history and mythology as you translate the works of historians, poets and politicians.”

Mathematics (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Route 1: Grade A or above in Mathematics **and** Grade B or above in GCSE Further Mathematics.

Route 2: Grade A or above in GCSE Mathematics.

Both routes require modules M4 and M8 to be taken at GCSE level.

Those students entering through Route 2 will be kept together in the +2 class where they receive 2 extra Mathematics periods over the two-week timetable cycle unless timetable restrictions require external students to be timetabled for this class to allow access into the College.

Content

AS Mathematics

AS1: Pure Mathematics

Algebra and functions, Co-ordinate geometry in (x,y) plane, Binomial expansions, Trigonometry, Exponentials and logarithms, Differentiation, Integration, Vectors

AS2: Applied Mathematics [Mechanics/Statistics]

Kinematics, Forces and Newton's laws, Sampling, Data presentation and interpretation, Probability, Statistical distributions

Assessment

AS1: Written examination 1 hour 45 minutes

AS2: Written examination 1 hour 15 minutes

Content

A2 Mathematics

A21: Pure Mathematics

Algebra and functions, Co-ordinate geometry in (x,y) plane, Sequences and series, Trigonometry, Differentiation, Integration, Numerical methods

A22: Applied Mathematics [Mechanics/Statistics]

Kinematics, Moments, Impulse and momentum, Probability, Statistical distributions, Hypothesis testing

Assessment

A21: Written examination 2 hours 30 minutes

A22: Written examination 1 hr 30 minutes

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Mathematics continues to be one of the most popular AS/A2 subjects within MCB.

Students have developed strengths in the subject at GCSE Level and have a natural curiosity as to how topics are extended at AS/A2 Level.

As a key STEM subject, Mathematics develops key innovative transferable skills which build into many other subjects particularly within Science, Technology, Business Studies and Economics.

Studying Mathematics at AS/A2 Level provides the key to many developing sectors including ICT, accountancy, actuary, finance, medicine, dentistry, engineering and data analysis.

The majority of our A2 students move into university courses which have significant mathematical application whilst others move directly into STEM related posts with the option of further study.

From a student:

"I've loved studying A Level Maths! It's been challenging at times, but that's partly what has made it so enjoyable. Maths has really boosted my confidence and taught me how to approach difficult situations logically—not just in class, but in everyday life too. It's a subject that has opened doors for me and I'm sure will continue to do so as I move on from Methody."

Moving Image Arts (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in GCSE Moving Image Arts. A genuine interest in film. Strong lens-based skills. An ability to juggle coursework deadlines. Initiative and willingness to work independently in the development of personal ideas for film. Strong organisational skills and skills in extended writing as there is substantial written work at both AS and A2 Level.

Desirable

Access to a film camera outside school would be useful. A grade B or above in English Language is desirable due to the requirement for extended writing.

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Foundation Portfolio – pre-production materials, 3-4 minute film or animation, evaluation (Statement of Intentions and Evaluation 2,600 words) AS 2: Critical Response: 1 hr 30-minute online exam with questions on clips from set study areas.	AS 1: 60% of AS, 24% of A Level AS 2: 40% of AS, 16 % of A Level
A2 1: Advanced Portfolio – Illustrated Essay and Evaluation 2700 words, pre-production materials, 5–7-minute film or shorter animation.	A21: 36% of A Level A22: 24% of A Level
A2 2: Advanced Critical Response: 2 hr 15-minute online exam with questions based on clips from set study areas and unseen clips	CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Students go on to study a wide range of degree courses in film and broadcasting.

Employment

The Creative Industries is one of the fastest growing areas of the UK economy with diverse career opportunities within film and related areas.

Other

Apprenticeships for young people are available through organisations such as Northern Ireland Creative Employment Programme and NI Screen.

From a student:

“Moving Image Arts is a fantastic subject. It has an incredible balance between coursework and theory; you get to learn about the history of cinema through the 20th century, and simultaneously explore your own film-making ideas. I would thoroughly recommend this subject for any student interested in media, broadcasting, or the creative arts- MIA will definitely shine in your portfolio.”

Music (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in GCSE Music along with Grade 5 in voice or instrument

Desirable

Grade 5 theory

Keen interest on all types of Music and willingness to get involved in performance opportunities.

Content

AS 1: Solo performance and composition

AS 2: Aural and Written papers

A2 1: Solo performance and composition

A2 2: Aural and Written papers

Assessment

AS 1: 64% One performance of between 5-7 minutes-external examiner. One piece of original composition

AS 2: 36% One Aural paper-1 hour and one written paper-2 hours-based on set works.

A2 1: 60% One performance of between 8-10 minutes-external examiner. One piece of original composition

A2 2: 40% One Aural paper-1 hour and one written paper-2 hours-based on set works.

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/Higher Education

Most universities offer music degrees and many also offer music technology. Many pupils go to music colleges which specialise in their chosen instrument or voice. Some students gain choral scholarships to sing in university choirs.

Employment

Broadcasting, Composing, Journalism, Music industry support work, Music technology and musical instrument technology, Music therapy, Sound recording, Teaching, Performing, Conducting, Librarianship e.g., in an orchestra
Musical administration

Other

Some students join the forces and audition for military bands. Some go directly into careers involving music publishing. Some go to Belfast Met to study Music Technology.

From a student:

"I really recommend doing A Level music because it helps you to gain so much more understanding and appreciation when listening to and playing all types of music, as well as being in a class of like-minded people who share your interests and motivate you to do your best, resulting in a really enjoyable and engaging course to study."

Nutrition and Food Science (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B or above in GCSE Food and Nutrition. If no GCSE Food and Nutrition, a grade B or above in Biology or Chemistry, or BB in Double Award Science.

Points to note:

There is no cooking at A Level in this subject. At A2 the research project allows for flexibility of choice, so that students can specialise in individual areas of interest to them.

Desirable

An interest in Food and Nutrition issues along with the ability to work independently, manage time and meet deadlines.

Content

AS Unit 1: Principals of Nutrition - the study of macronutrients and micronutrients and other dietary constituents.

AS Unit 2: Diet, Lifestyle and Health - students investigate current research on diet, lifestyle and health such as eating patterns.

A2 Unit 1: Food Safety and Quality – the study of securing safe food supply from primary producer to consumer such as food safety.

A2 Unit 2: Coursework Assignment – a 4,000-word report on student's own choice research-based activity. The students chosen topic should come from a topic covered in the A Level course.

Assessment

AS Unit 1 Written paper (1½ hours)
20% of A Level

AS Unit 2 Written paper (1½ hours)
20% of A Level

A2 Unit 1 Written paper (2 ½ hours)
30% of A Level

A2 Unit 2 Internally assessed coursework 30% of A Level

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/Higher Education

The course provides a good foundation for higher education courses such as medicine, dietetics, sports science, food science, nursing, consumer studies, business studies and marketing.

Employment

Nutrition and Food Science is a fast-moving discipline that focuses on understanding the role of diet in maintaining a healthy human body and preventing disease. There are many career opportunities both at home and worldwide within this field of work as scientific knowledge and research development.

From a student:

“What I love about Nutrition and Food Science is that it is so relevant to everyday life, meaning you can constantly enjoy your knowledge outside of the classroom. Nutrition and Food Science is a very up-and-coming subject as the increased imbalance between food and population and pandemics, such as obesity, are becoming more prevalent in our world. I plan to study Food Science and Nutrition at university, as it is a broad topic which can branch into many exciting and innovative career opportunities.”

Physics (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade A or above in Physics and Mathematics.

No foundation papers can be taken. Mathematics must be M4/M8.

Double Award Science grade AA with A grade in Physics element.

Desirable

Physics is closely linked to Mathematics, so studying the two together can improve your skills in both.

It is therefore recommended that those choosing A Level Physics will have already studied GCSE Further Mathematics and/or are intending to study AS/A2 Mathematics.

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Forces, Energy and Electricity AS 2: Waves, Photons and Astronomy AS 3: Practical Techniques and Data Analysis A2 1: Deformation of Solids, Thermal Physics, Circular Motions, Oscillations and Atomic and Nuclear Physics A2 2: Fields, Capacitors and Particle Physics A2 3: Practical Techniques and Data Analysis	AS 1: 1 hour 45 minutes examination (16%) AS 2: 1 hour 45 minutes examination (16%) AS 3: 2 x 1-hour examinations (8%) A2 1: 2-hour examination (24%) A2 2: 2-hour examination (24%) A2 3: 2 x 1-hour examinations (12%) CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/Higher Education

Physics A Level can be useful for getting on to a wide range of university courses e.g., Engineering.

Employment

Use your knowledge to develop new materials, machinery, and technology to improve our lives and help us explore the universe further, from computers to telescopes and spacecraft.

Other

For useful information on Careers via school, technical and University routes, view the Institute of Physics website at www.iop.org/careers/index.

From a student:

"I was good at GCSE Physics and really enjoyed studying the different topics. It enhanced my understanding of the fundamentals of how our modern world works. I carried it on to A Level, both because I enjoyed it, and because it was essential for the University course I was applying to."

Psychology (AQA, Linear)

Entry Criteria

Psychology is the study of the human brain and behaviour. It is a Social Science and study at A Level will provide a solid understanding of How Science Works through engaging in a variety of scientific investigations and mathematical analysis.

Essential

A, B, B from Mathematics, English Language and Science (Chemistry, Physics or Biology or a BB in Double Award Science). Please note that whilst ABB is required, the A grade can be achieved in any of the 3 subjects.

Content AS 1: Introductory topics in Psychology: Social Influence Memory Attachment AS 2: Psychology in Context: Approaches in Psychology Research Methods Psychopathology A Level 1: Issues and Options in Psychology: Approaches and Biopsychology Research methods A Level 2: Options - Schizophrenia; Forensic Psych, Cognition & Development	Assessment Paper 1: 2 hours Introductory topics in Psychology Paper 2: 2 hours Psychology in Context Paper 3: 2 hours Issues and Options in Psychology All papers taken at end of second year of study. AQA Specification
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What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Psychology provides a good introduction to higher education within the subject area but keeps paths open to explore the sciences and arts.

Employment

Psychology forms a significant component of: Medicine and related disciplines, Sales and Marketing, Human Resources Governmental departments, Law, Social work and Education.

Other:

Psychology promotes the development of scientific theories into how the mind and body works and encourages the application of these to all aspects of life today.

From a student:

"I really enjoyed studying Psychology, coming out of GCSE's I was ready for a change, Psychology was new and different to anything I had studied before. It has been interesting to see the key role of clinical psychologists within the field of law. They assess people where they may be unfit to be tried."

Religious Studies (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B in GCSE Religious Studies.

If Religious Studies has not been taken at GCSE, then grade B in either English Language or History is required.

Desirable

Students should have an enquiring, critical and sympathetic approach to the study of religion. They should be willing to explore the way in which faith affects thinking and behaviour and to develop their knowledge and understanding of religion and ethics. Finally, students should be willing to reflect on and develop their own values, opinions and attitudes.

Content	Assessment
AS 1: An Introduction to the Acts of the Apostles AS 2: Foundations of Ethics with Special Reference to Issues in Medical Ethics	AS 1: Examination 1 hour 20 minutes AS 2: Examination 1 hour 20 minutes
A2 1: Themes in Selected Letters of St Paul A2 2: Global Ethics	A2 1: Examination 2 hours A2 2: Examination 2 hours CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/Higher Education

Religious Studies can lead to the study of theology and religion. However, it can also give access to a wide variety of arts and science courses.

Employment

Suitable for students who want to have an understanding of ethical and moral issues in a wide range of careers or issues of religion and faith in public life.

Other

Suitable for students who want to have an understanding of ethical and moral issues in a wide range of careers or issues of religion and faith in public life.

From a student:

"Religious Studies provides the opportunity to engage in class debate and improve your essay writing skills, while expanding your knowledge of topical issues, both religious and ethical. We would encourage you to study this subject as it provides essential skills for both university and life in the world of work."

Russian (EDEXCEL, Linear)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Level 6 at GCSE (EDEXCEL)

Desirable

An interest in effective communication with others.

A willingness to develop your cultural and critical sensitivity.

A desire to learn more about literature, the arts, intellectual ideas, linguistics and history

Content

A2 1: Listening, reading and translation **A2 2:** Response to literary and film texts **A2 3:** Speaking

The topics covered are Russian Society and Culture in the post-soviet world. Perestroika and the collapse of the Soviet Union.

Assessment

A2 1: Listening, reading and translation

A2 2: Two essays in Russian in response to a literary text and film.

A2 3: 2-minute presentation, 5-minute discussion and 9- minute conversation.

[EDEXCEL Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

It is possible to study Russian on its own or jointly with other subjects, such as another language, business or management.

Employment

Education, Journalism, Broadcasting, International Business, Advertising and Marketing, Tourism, Civil and Public Service, Diplomacy

Other:

Academic and research Communities

From a student:

“Learning Russian has given me more choices when applying to different university courses and it has been great fun as the classes are small.”

Spanish (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade B at CCEA or equivalent.

Desirable

A lively interest in Spanish language and culture

A desire to learn more about the Spanish speaking world

An interest in Hispanic literature

Content

AS 1: Speaking

AS 2: Listening, Reading and Use of Language

AS 3: Extended Writing (One essay in Spanish in response to a set film or literary text)

A2 1: Speaking

A2 2: Listening and Reading

A2 3: Extended Writing (One essay in Spanish in response to a literary text)

Assessment

AS 1: 3-minute presentation and 8-minute conversation

AS 2: Listening comprehension, reading comprehension, translation from Spanish into English, grammatical and lexical exercises

AS 3: One essay in Spanish in response to a set film or literary text

A2 1: 6-minute discussion and 9-minute conversation

A2 2: Listening, reading comprehension, summary and translation

A2 3: One essay in Spanish in response to a literary text

[CCEA Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

B.A. in Spanish or combined with another subject, e.g. Spanish and Law

Employment

Translating, Interpreting, Media, Business and International Relations, Travel and Tourism, Education

From a student:

"I am really enjoying studying Spanish A Level. It has equipped me with lifelong skills, such as effective communication, research and analytical skills. Furthermore, it has been fascinating learning about current and historical issues in Spain. Spanish is incredibly useful as it opens a lot of doors in varied career paths."

Sport (BTEC) (Pearson, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade C* or above in English Language and Mathematics. A keen interest in Sport, Health and Fitness is essential.

Desirable

An interest in studying a sports related course at university
Takes part in regular sport or physical training

Content

AS 1: Anatomy and Physiology
AS 2: Fitness Training and Programming for Health, Sport and Well-being

A2 1: Fitness Testing
A2 2: Professional Development in the Sports Industry

Assessment

AS 1: Anatomy and Physiology - 1hr 30min exam in January of L6th
AS 2: Fitness Training and Programming for Health, Sport and Well-being - 2hr 30min Controlled Assessment Exam in May of L6th
A2 1: Fitness Testing – Coursework in U6th
A2 2: Professional Development in the Sports Industry – Coursework in U6th

[Pearson Specification](#)

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education

Satisfies the entry requirements for all sport related degree courses – is equal in UCAS points to 1 A-level

Further/ Higher Education

Satisfies the entry requirements for all sport related degree courses – is equal in UCAS points to 1 A-Level

From a student:

“I struggled greatly with examinations; the BTEC in Sport meant a reduced volume of revision. It allowed me to focus on my assignments throughout the two years and I was able to achieve a Distinction * Grade (A* equivalent). Consequently, I gained a place in a Primary School training college to become a teacher.”

Technology and Design (CCEA, Modular)

Entry Criteria

In this course, students explore Technology and Design in a range of different contexts and scenarios, from the home and community to the world of business and industry. The course appeals to those who have an enquiring mind, a desire to solve problems and a sense of how the modern world deals with changing trends and demands.

Essential

Grade B or above in GCSE Technology and Design, or a B in Mathematics **or** Physics, **or** BB in Double Award Science with B in Physics component

Desirable

Good ability to work independently, time manage and meet deadlines.

Content	Assessment
AS 1: Design and Materials and Systems and Electronic and Microelectronic Control Systems	AS 1: Design and Materials and Systems and Electronic and Microelectronic Control Systems
AS 2: Internal Assessment – Product Development	AS 2: Internal Assessment – Product Development
A2 1: Product Design	A2 1: Product Design
A2 2: Internal Assessment – Product/System Design and Manufacture	A2 2: Internal Assessment – Product/System Design and Manufacture
	CCEA Specification

What can you do with this subject?

A qualification in Technology and Design can provide you with a basis for study in further or higher education in a wide range of disciplines such as engineering, product development and product design.

The qualification could also be used as an entry route into an apprenticeship in a career such as engineering. The range of career options open to you is very wide due to the nature of GCE Technology and Design as it involves problem-solving, application of scientific principles to the design of products, the process of design itself and the use of materials and techniques such as computer-aided design. This can provide you with a useful basis for entry into careers such as product design, engineering, graphic design, teaching and architecture.

From a student:

“I really enjoy studying Technology at A Level because I am gaining an understanding of how products are developed; systems work and how everyday items are manufactured. I enjoy the challenge of the practical work and how I have developed as an independent learner through the course. I like that we get to use tools such as the 3D printer and Laser cutter as it gives me a great understanding of how items are made in industry.”

Travel and Tourism (BTEC) (Pearson, Modular)

Entry Criteria

Essential

Grade C* or above in English Language **and** Mathematics.

Desirable

An interest in the wider world, and a desire to follow a career path in Travel and Tourism or Geographical related studies.

Content	Assessment
Lower 6th UNIT 1 – The World of Travel and Tourism UNIT 2 – Global Destinations	UNIT 1 – (90 GLH teaching) Written examination – 1.5 hours – 75 marks UNIT 2 – (120 GLH teaching) Task set and marked externally, completed under supervised conditions – 3 hours – 60 marks UNIT 3 – (90 GLH teaching) Internally marked coursework
Upper 6th UNIT 3 – Principles of Marketing in Travel and Tourism UNIT 9 – Visitor Attractions	UNIT 9 (60 GLH teaching) Internally marked coursework UNIT 11 (60 GLH teaching) Internally marked coursework Pearson Specification

What can you do with this subject?

Further/ Higher Education:

BTEC Higher National in Travel and Tourism, Undergraduate degree in Travel and Tourism, or links to other degree courses e.g. Geography.

Employment:

Airline employment, hotel management, international business management, tour manager, travel agent, resort representative, resort management.

Learners will develop transferable skills such as presenting and communication, which are highly regarded by employers and higher education providers.

From a student:

"I am really interested in travelling the world when I leave school. It would be great if I could get a job in the travel industry. I much prefer coursework to exam-based subjects, so BTEC Travel and Tourism is the perfect subject for me!"



**METHODIST
COLLEGE
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